The Unsent Letter

Silvia, I found this in the cedar chest of the Sanctuary, under the oldest charts. An Oracle of long ago wrote it, centuries before me, to the Mirror Speaker of Tower III, and never sent it. She wrote it the way the glass sees, as the people of the mirror do. Hold the page up to a mirror and read it.

A.

To the Mirror Speaker of the third tower,

Forgive me. I closed my door to you when your crossed the plateau to see me, and I have been sorry every night since.

Now hear what only we two know. Your mirror did not fall. We broke it together, into nine pieces, and we hid each piece in a different room of your theatre. While the nine are apart, no one can turn the Astrolabe alone: not the Order, not you, not I.

And beware the Ashes. They were old before the Order was born. They keep a fire older than our first star, and they want what the Astrolabe opens. They will come to your smiling.

The first piece sleeps behind a thousand faces. Only the one who sees what is not equal will find it.

The Oracle of the Sandstone Sanctuary

In the mirror the words turn round, and so do the people who wrote them. Tower III is the house of the mirror: there, everything may be the other way round.

A.

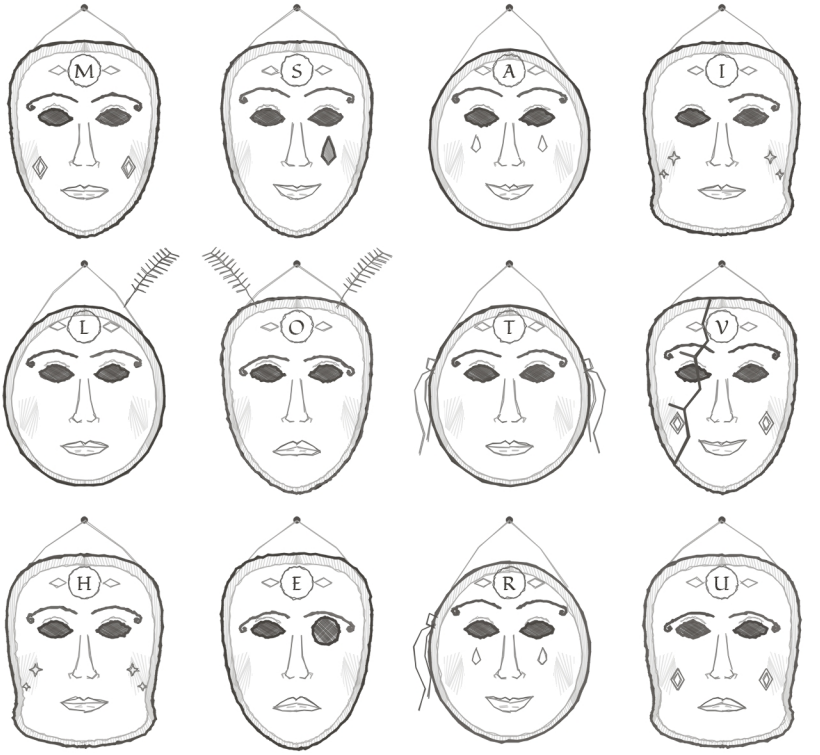
Leonardo wrote his notebooks the same way, from right to left. I always thought he did it to hide his secrets. Perhaps he only wanted to be read by someone patient.

H.

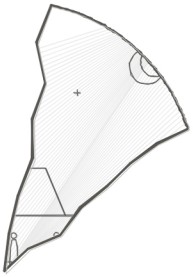
The Gate of a Thousand Masks

The door of Tower III is a wall of masks, and each mask is half a face held up to a mirror. A true face is the same on both sides. Six of these twelve masks lie: their two halves are not equal.

Find the six that lie. Read the letters on their foreheads from left to right, row by row: that is the word the gate is waiting for.



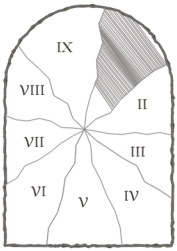
The word of the gate: ☐☐☐☐☐☐



Fragment I

When the gate opens, the first piece of the mirror of Tower III is yours. Keep it: nine pieces make one glass, and the whole glass shows the way.

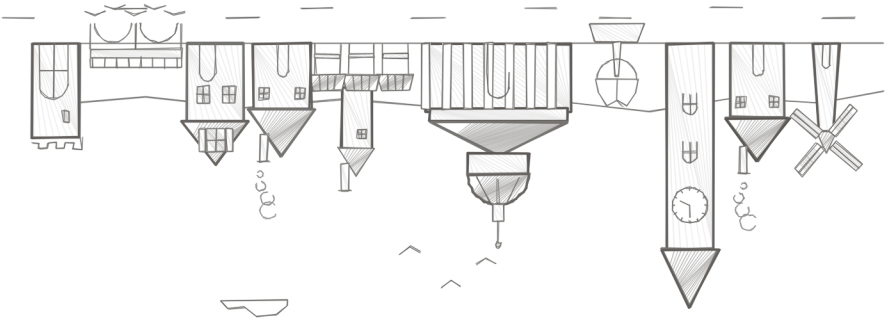
Its place in the mirror →



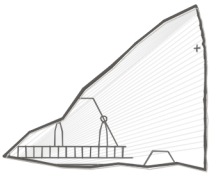
The Camera Obscura

A dark room with one small hole in its wall. Through the hole the whole city of the third tower falls on the wall, upside down. This is the city as it stood the day before the raiders came, drawn the way the wall shows it: upside down.

Keep this sheet beside you. In the dark room the city is turned the same way, and four things in it have changed since this drawing was made. Find them. The raiders carry their fire wherever they go.

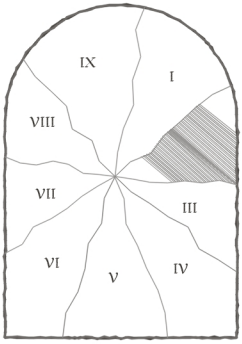


Look at the sky, the roofs, the shutters and the street.



Fragment II

The second piece of the mirror of Tower III. It is yours when the room opens.



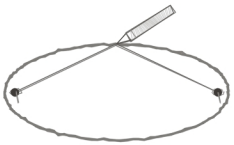
Its place in the mirror

The seal of this room. Scan it with your camera when the door asks for it.

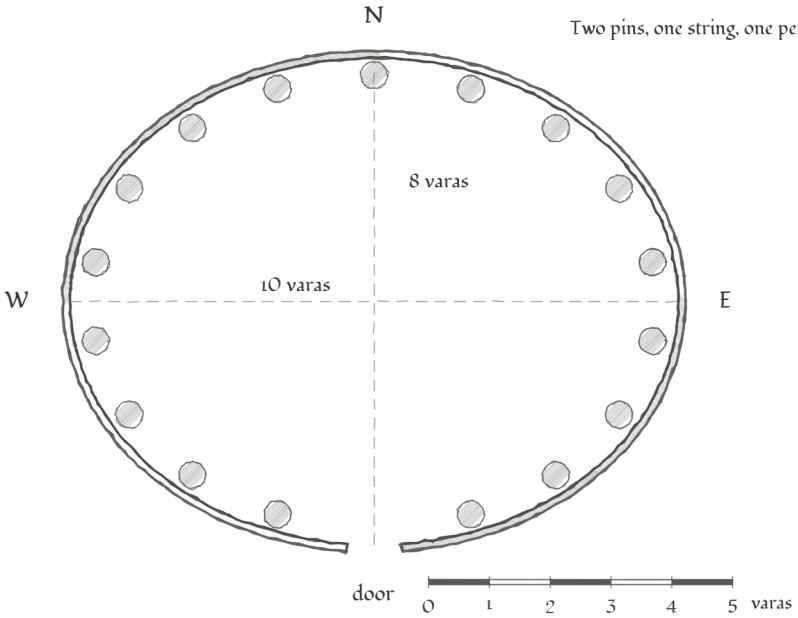
The Whispering Gallery

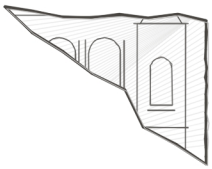
Under the narrow house a second stair goes down to a long hall with no corners. The Order laid it out the way Kepler drew the paths of the planets: two pins in the floor, a string of ten varas, and a pencil pulled tight around them. A whisper at one pin is heard at the other, clear as a bell. Nowhere else.

The pins are gone, but the string never stretched. Find where they stood. The raiders whisper at the east pin: stand at the west one, and listen. What you hear must be answered the way a mirror answers.



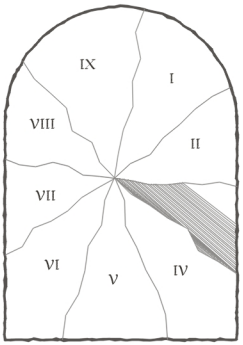
Two pins, one string, one pencil.





Fragment III

The third piece of the mirror of Tower III. It is yours when the room opens.



Its place in the mirror



The seal of this room. Scan it with your camera when the door asks for it.